	7.6. MEASUREMENT PROCEDURES	
	Document no: ASMF7.6	
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MEASUREMENT PROCEDURES

Objective

To ensure that all measurement procedures used in the production and characterization of proficiency testing samples and reference materials (RMs/CRMs) are **fit for purpose**, scientifically valid, traceable, and consistently applied.

1. Selection of Measurement Procedures

- Use procedures that are:
- Technically appropriate for the property being measured (e.g. ISO 1928 for CV, ISO 562 for Volatile, ISO 1171 for ash etc.)
- Internationally recognised standards such as ISO, ASTM, SANAS endorsed etc.
- Validated in-house if they are not internationally recognised

2. Validation of Methods

- Validation evidence must be available for each method used in the production or characterisation.
- The validation should cover things like: Accuracy, Precision (repeatability and reproducibility), Limit of detection (if applicable), linearity, Robustness and Ruggedness
- In-house methods must include detailed SOPs and full method validation reports

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3. Documentation of Procedures

- Each method must be documented as SOP and should include:

- Scope and applicability
- Equipment and materials required
- Step-by-step method
- Calibration requirements
- Quality control checks
- Safety considerations

4. Application during PT & RM Production

- Apply selected and validated measurement procedures consistently throughout

  - Homogeneity testing
  - Characterisation
  - Stability studies

ALL PROCEDURES MUST BE FOLLOWED EXACTLY AS WRITTEN; ANY DEVIATIONS MUST BE RECORED AND JUSTIFIED

5. Control of Measurement Quality

- Use quality control measures such as : Reference standards or internal controls, control charts or duplicate analysis, calibration checks.
- Regularly evaluate method performance and investigate trends and outliers

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6. Link to Measurement Uncertainty

- Each method must support estimation of measurement uncertainty
- Procedure should include identification of significant uncertainty contributors, such as repeatability, weighing errors, environmental effects.